PARK & PIPE

CATEGORY WINNER!

For the second year in a row, Mammoth pulls best park/pipe honors.

By Jeff Foss

Special Ingredients

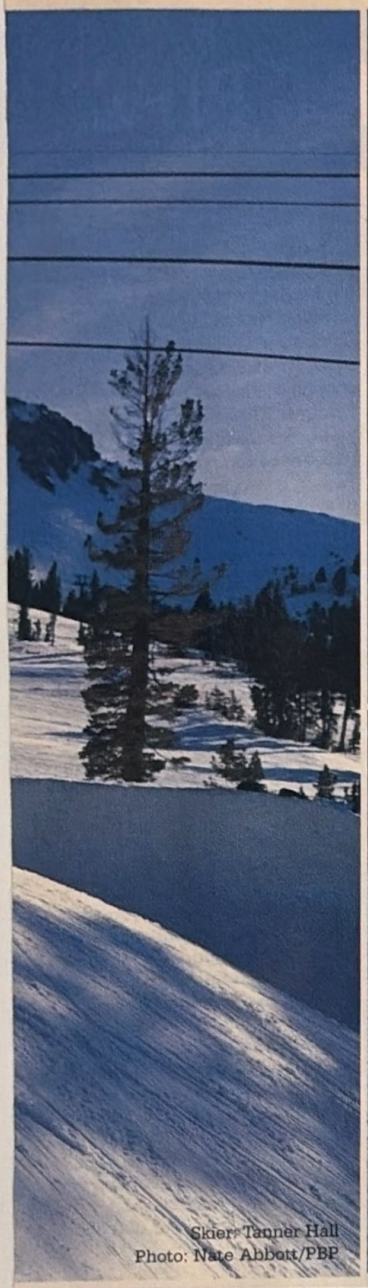
From upper management to first-year lifties, everyone at Mammoth Mountain knows the deal: the Unbound Terrain Park is a top priority with a world-class reputation to uphold. Three pipes, 35-plus jibs, 75 to 100 hits—this park is more self-contained than a TV dinner. Mammoth employs five full-time welders who do all their jib construction in-house; an arsenal of heavy-duty earth-moving equipment including seven park-specific snowcats and three burly pipe cutters (a Zaugg Pipemonster, a Superdragon, and a regular Pipedragon), two dozen crew members, and over a million dollars in marketing and operating budgets. What does all this amount to? Commitment and an attention to detail you won't find anywhere else.

What's What, Who's Who

Pros galore have called Unbound's 65-acre, 2,000-vertical-foot exotic expanse "home"—Tanner Hall; Pep Fujas; Phils Larose, Belanger, and Dion; Rory Silva; JF Cusson; and Sarah Burke and Kristi Leskinen have honed their park skills as residents of Mammoth Lakes. "Having big-name pros is huge," says Mammoth Terrain Park Manager Oren Tanzer. "Kids see them here in person, magazines, or movies, and it makes them want to check it out." Oren knows that in order to attract heavy-hitting pros and nervous beginners alike, it's important to maintain a wide variety of goods. That's why Mammoth builds everything from impish rails and jumps to cartoonishly large tabletops (55, 70, and 75 footers in a line) and redonkulous jibs (60-foot-long S-boxes).

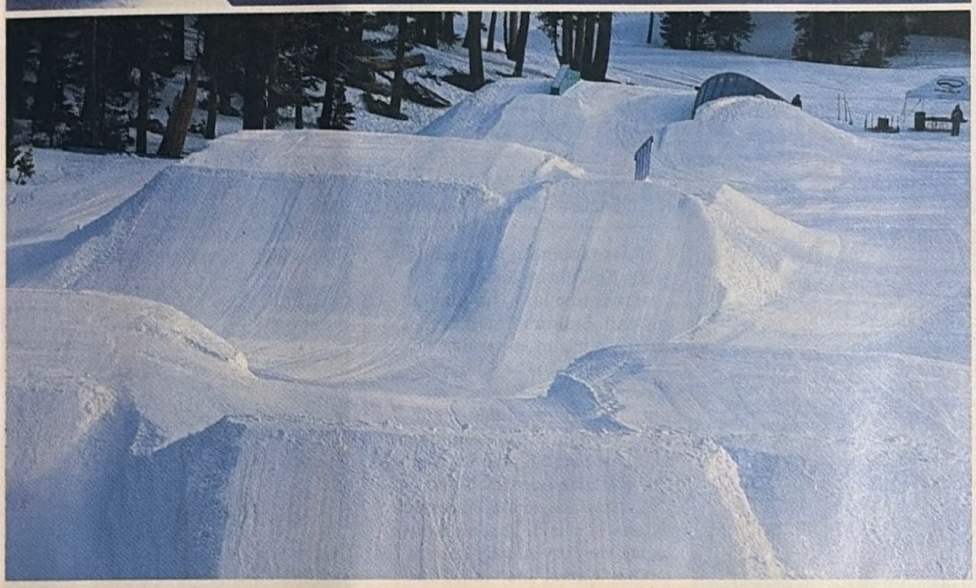
That's Just Absurd

Speaking of larger-than-life terrain, Mammoth wears the pants when it comes to sick and twisted features. Last season's 64-foot S-box was an amazing success, despite the fact that it weighed two tons and cost Mammoth around 8,000 dollars (1,500 for the paint job alone). The massive spine that Candide airs over in MSP's *The Front Line*? Try 50,000 dollars. Of course, that's four snowcats and an industrial-sized excavator working sixteen-hour days for a week straight. Oren knows you gotta spend money to make money, and his latest creation—a gigantic stepped box—promises to be yet another hit with the kiddies.



Skier: Tanner Hall
Photo: Nate Abbott/PBP

O'Connell



Pipe Dreams

At Mammoth you'll find a stock halfpipe (350 feet long with twelve-foot walls), a sculpted Superpipe (450 feet long with fifteen-foot walls), and an outrageous "Super Duper Pipe" (600 feet long with eighteen-foot walls and a twenty-foot transition). Just down the road is June Mountain, home of another pristine Superpipe (500 feet long with fifteen-foot walls) and open to you, Mammoth ticket holder. Thanks to an alliance between the two resorts, you have better pipe access than most Widespread Panic fans!

Sittin' Pretty

Mammoth plans to retain its park-and-pipe title for a long while. The mountain estimates that a full one-third of its total business comes from kids specifically looking for jumps and jibs, and that over 400,000 people make their way through the terrain park each year. These numbers send a perfectly clear message to Mammoth executives: do absolutely whatever it takes, year after year, to maintain a top-of-the-line park.

QUICK STATS!

1-800-MAMMOTH
mammoth-mtn.com

Number Of Trails:	150
Number Of Lifts:	29
Base Elevation:	7,953 feet
Summit Elevation:	11,153 feet
Total Vertical:	3,100 feet
Skiable Terrain in Acreage:	3,500 acres
Annual Snowfall:	385 inches
Closest Airport:	Reno International, 3 hours
Ticket And Pass Prices:	
Adult Season Pass:	$1,200
Adult Lift Ticket:	$62
Young Adult Season Pass:	$900
Young Adult Lift Ticket (13–18):	$47